

Dennie Declercq // @DennieDeclercq // #DreamingIsBelieving



Autism: From Bullied to MVP





Who am I?

- Dennie Declercq
- Volunteer developer!
- Autism
- Microsoft MVP
- DDSoft (nonprofit)
- #DreamingIsBelieving
- Positive thinker



Bullying lead to concussion



Before special school

- Extreme bullying

After

- Not bullied anymore
- Feeling relieved

Then

- Boredom



Another school

- Low Math level
- Giving Technical school a chance
- Bullied again

Trauma

School for students with autism

- Accountancy
 - Bullied with support
 - Mix: Hard days
 - Better days
-
- Learned about autism after all





For dummies?

- 16 Years old
 - Asked to a teacher: "Can I learn program on my own?"?
 - Buy a book for dummies...
-
- DUMMIES?

- Wanted high school
- Changed to adult school
- Boring factory job
- Bullied again

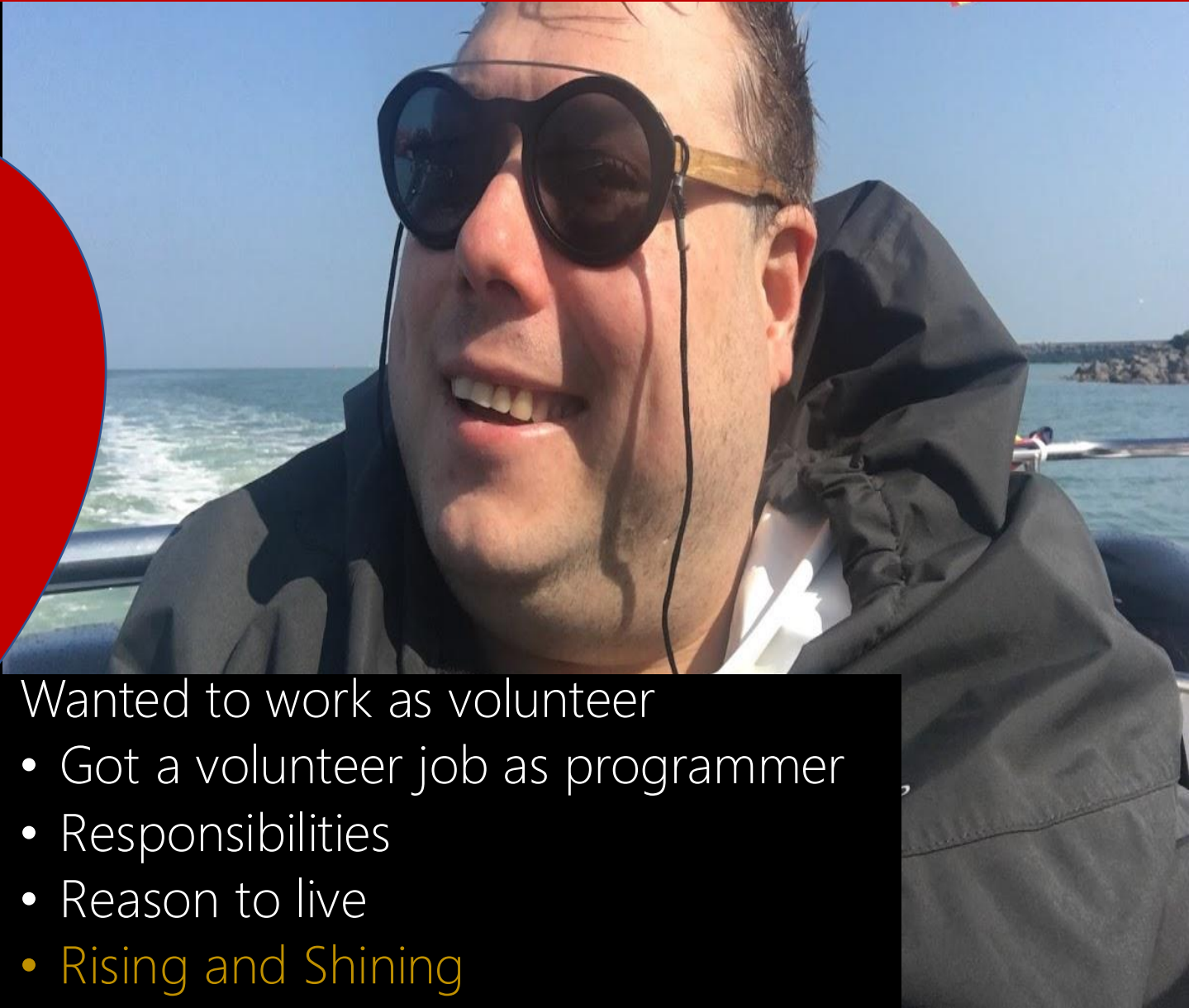
I love Fridays!



I found love

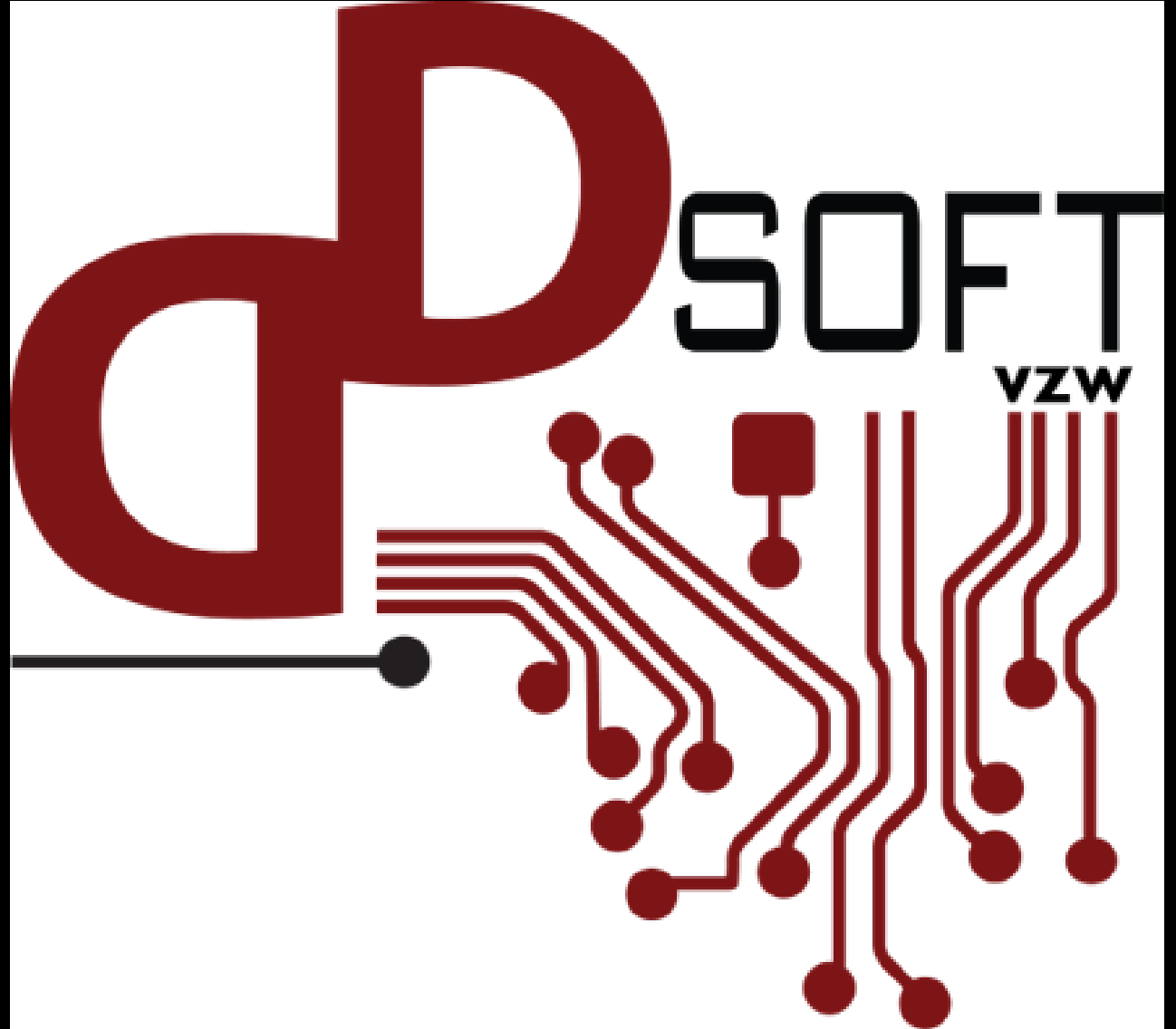


- Wanted to work as volunteer
- Got a volunteer job as programmer
 - Responsibilities
 - Reason to live
 - Rising and Shining



DDSoft

- Only 1 year later
- In combination with Ithaka
- My own nonprofit
- I am a programmer!



2017 Start public speaking // Sydney!

- Start speaker career
- First conference: NDC Sydney
- 2018 – 2019 More and more international talks
- #DreamingIsBelieving





#7ThYearMagic

August 2019 – Microsoft MVP



- Finally achieved something!
- I make sense!
- I Belong

My Pride

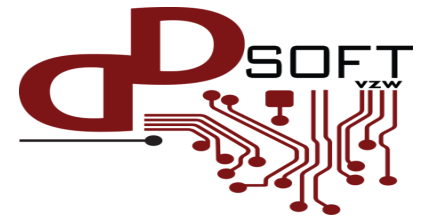
- Always:
 - Programming
 - Hard learning
 - Tech conversations
 - BELIEVE IN MYSELF
 - Wanted to proof myself



Thanks! || Q&A



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